



THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

FROM DEMOCRACY TO DICTATORSHIP: HOW DID HITLER DESTROY THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC?

*Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39 – Key
Topic 4: Life in Nazi Germany, 1933–39*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1/Q3A INFERENCE)			
L2: Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1) / JUNE 2025 (Q2B CAUSATION)			
L3: Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2) / JUNE 2025 (Q3A UTILITY)			
L4: Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q3B-D INTERPRETATIONS)			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the laws and incentives used to increase the birth rate and promote traditional marriage.
- ☐ Analyse the methods used by the NS-Fraenschaft and the Deutsches Frauenwerk to control women's daily lives and education.
- ☐ Evaluate the 'great contradiction' of Nazi policy: why female employment actually increased between 1933 and 1939 despite ideological attempts to force women out of the workplace.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who was Joseph Goebbels?

Name two methods of Nazi propaganda.

Who were the SS (Schutzstaffel)?

What was the Gestapo?

What was the role of concentration camps in the 1930s?

What was the Enabling Act?

What was the Night of the Long Knives?

Who was Ernst Röhm?

What happened to the Reichstag in 1933?

What title did Hitler take in 1934?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

Kinder, Küche, Kirche | Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933) | The Mother's Cross (Mutterkreuz) | Lebensborn (Spring of Life) | NS-Frauenschaft (NSF) | Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW) | Gertrud Scholtz-Klink

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did Nazi policies towards women succeed in their goals?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete these sentences based on the lesson's core narrative: 1) Nazi policies aimed to confine women to the roles of "Kinder, Küche, Kirche" BUT... 2) The Law for the Encouragement of Marriage was introduced BECAUSE... 3) The Nazis created organizations like the NS-Frauenschaft SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using the keywords 'Kinder, Küche, Kirche', 'Law for the Encouragement of Marriage', 'The Mother's Cross', and 'Gertrud Scholtz-Klink', write a short paragraph explaining how Nazi policies aimed to shape women's lives in the 1930s.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how the Nazi ideology of racial purity and the urgent need for population growth led directly to the implementation of programs like the 'Lebensborn' and the creation of 'The Mother's Cross'.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. What if the Nazi regime had not faced severe labour shortages due to rearmament? How might their policies towards women's employment have evolved differently, and what would be the long-term implications for German society?

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: Extract from a speech by Hitler to the National Socialist Women's Organisation, 1934.

"The slogan 'Emancipation of women' was invented by Jewish intellectuals... Her world is her husband, her family, her children, and her home. We do not consider it correct for the woman to interfere in the world of the man."

Q6. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about Nazi views on the role of women in German society.

(i) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this: EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1/Q3A INFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

General Notes

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L2: Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the school curriculum and teaching profession were completely 'Nazified' by Bernhard Rust.
- ☐ Analyse the differences between the youth movements for boys (military preparation) and girls (domestic preparation).
- ☐ Evaluate the extent to which Nazi youth policies were a success, acknowledging the Grade 9 nuance that resistance did exist.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What were the 'Three Ks' for women in Nazi Germany?

What was the Law for the Encouragement of Marriage?

What was the Mother's Cross?

What was the Hitler Youth?

How did schools change under the Nazis?

Who was Joseph Goebbels?

What was the Gestapo?

Who led the SS?

What was the Enabling Act?

Who were the 'November Criminals'?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Indoctrination | National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB) | Bernhard Rust | Eugenics (Race Studies) | Hitlerjugend (HJ) | Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) | Faith and Beauty Society

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Were the Hitler Youth effective in controlling the young?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson: 1) The Nazi regime introduced significant changes to the school curriculum BUT... 2) Membership in the Hitlerjugend (HJ) and Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) became compulsory BECAUSE... 3) Teachers faced pressure to join the NSLB and swear loyalty to Hitler, SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Explain how the following keywords relate to Nazi policies towards the young, using specific examples from the lesson narrative: Indoctrination, National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB), Eugenics (Race Studies), Hitlerjugend (HJ), Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM).

Causal Linkage

Q4. How did the Nazi regime's control over the education system and its establishment of compulsory youth organizations (HJ and BDM) *together* serve to consolidate their power and prepare Germany for its long-term goals by 1939?

The 'What If' Challenge

Q5. What if the Nazi regime had *failed* to gain significant control over the education system and youth organizations by 1939? How might this have impacted their ability to consolidate power, prepare for war, and maintain public support in the long term?

Q6. 2. Explain why Nazi policies towards the young were implemented, 1933–1939. .

You may use the following in your answer:

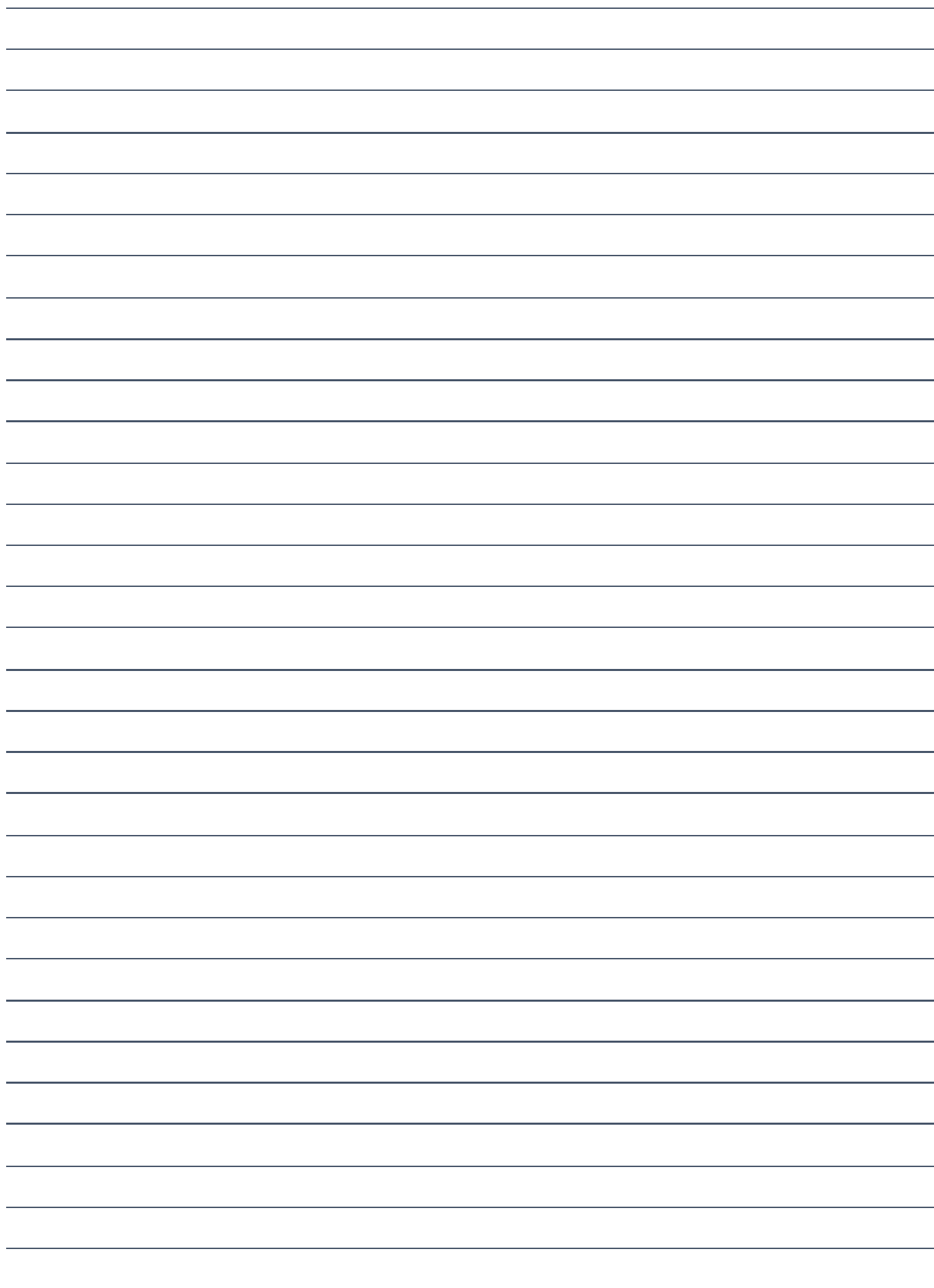
- **The Hitler Youth**
- **Education**

You must also use information of your own.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1) / JUNE 2025 (Q2B CAUSATION)

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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General Notes

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L3: Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the government schemes used to reduce unemployment (RAD, public works, and rearmament).
- ☐ Analyse the shift in economic leadership from Schacht's 'New Plan' to Goering's 'Four Year Plan' and the goal of Autarky.
- ☐ Evaluate the extent to which the Nazi economic recovery was a statistical illusion (invisible unemployment) and assess the true impact on living standards.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What were the 'Three Ks' (Kinder, Küche, Kirche) expected of women in Nazi Germany?

What financial incentive did the 1933 Law for the Encouragement of Marriage offer young couples?

What was the Mother's Cross awarded for?

What was the Hitler Youth (Hitlerjugend / HJ)?

What was the League of German Girls (Bund Deutscher Mädel / BDM)?

How did the school curriculum change under the Nazis?

Who were the Edelweiss Pirates?

Who was Joseph Goebbels?

What was the Gestapo?

What was the Night of the Long Knives (June 1934)?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Invisible Unemployment Autarky Ersatz Hermann Goering National Labour Service (RAD) German Labour Front (DAF) Strength Through Joy (KdF) Beauty of Labour (SdA)	
Power, Governance & Warfare	Economy, Trade & Society

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did living standards really improve for workers under the Nazis?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

True/False/Justify

Q2. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

1. Nazi Germany completely eliminated unemployment by 1939 through genuine, sustainable economic growth.

2. The Four Year Plan, led by Hermann Goering, aimed to make Germany economically self-sufficient and prepare for war.

3. Living standards for most Germans significantly improved between 1933 and 1939, with an abundance of consumer goods.

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how the Nazi regime managed both employment figures and public perception of living standards between 1933 and 1939. You must accurately use at least FIVE of the following keywords: Invisible Unemployment, Autarky, Ersatz, Hermann Goering, National Labour Service (RAD), German Labour Front (DAF), Strength Through Joy (KdF), Beauty of Labour (SdA). Underline or bold the keywords you use.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the complex relationship between the Nazi regime's rearmament goals, the official reduction in unemployment, and the actual living standards of ordinary Germans between 1933 and 1939. Your answer should clearly demonstrate how these three elements were interconnected and influenced each other.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine a scenario where, from 1933, the Nazi regime had genuinely prioritized improving the living standards of ordinary Germans through increased consumer goods production, higher real wages, and less emphasis on rearmament and autarky. How might this alternative economic strategy have impacted:

- 1. The regime's political stability and public support?**
- 2. Germany's international position and long-term geopolitical ambitions?**

Justify your reasoning with specific references to the core narrative and your understanding of Nazi ideology.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B: From a letter written by a German factory worker, 1937.

Through the Strength through Joy (KdF) scheme, our lives have genuinely improved. We are able to go on cheap weekly theater trips and even subsidized holidays that were completely beyond our reach before. There is a real sense of comradeship, and we feel that the government genuinely values our hard work.

Source C: From a report compiled by an undercover agent of the Social Democratic Party in exile (SOPADE), describing attitudes in a Berlin factory, 1938.

The workers are deeply unhappy. It is true that everyone has a job, but their wages are frozen and the price of food has risen significantly. They are forced to work longer hours under compulsory service, and heavy deductions are taken directly from their pay. The KdF trips are viewed as a propaganda circus that only a few highly paid party favorites can actually afford.

Q6. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into employment and living standards in Nazi Germany between 1933 and 1939?

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2) / JUNE 2025 (Q3A UTILITY)

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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General Notes

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L4: Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of Nazi racial ideology, distinguishing between 'Untermenschen' and 'Asocials'.
- ☐ Analyse the escalating stages of anti-Semitic persecution: from early boycotts (1933) to legislation (1935), bureaucratic dehumanisation (1938), and state-sponsored violence.
- ☐ Evaluate the brutal methods used against the disabled, Roma/Sinti, and homosexuals, including the Marzahn camp, sterilisation, and the T4 programme.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the National Labour Service (RAD)?

Name two ways the Nazis reduced official unemployment through 'invisible unemployment'.

What was 'Strength Through Joy' (Kraft durch Freude / KdF)?

What was the 'Beauty of Labour' (Schönheit der Arbeit / SdA)?

What organisation replaced all independent trade unions in May 1933?

What was the Volkswagen 'People's Car' scheme?

What were the 'Three Ks' expected of women under Nazi policy?

What was the Mother's Cross award?

What were the Edelweiss Pirates and Swing Youth?

What was the Gestapo?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Volksgemeinschaft | Social Darwinism | Untermenschen | Asocials | Anti-Semitism | Eugenics | Aryanisation

"Nazi racial policy defined the Volksgemeinschaft as an inclusive democratic community that protected Asocials and banned all Anti-Semitism and Aryanisation."

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: How did the Nazis justify the persecution of minorities?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

True/False/Justify

Q2. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific information from the lesson narrative.

- 1. The Nuremberg Laws primarily targeted 'asocials' and homosexuals, stripping them of their citizenship.**
- 2. Kristallnacht was a spontaneous, unorganised outburst of public anger against Jewish businesses and synagogues.**
- 3. The Nazi concept of 'Volksgemeinschaft' aimed to create a unified German society that embraced all citizens, regardless of their background or perceived deficiencies.**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least THREE of the keywords (Volksgemeinschaft, Social Darwinism, Untermenschen, Asocials, Anti-Semitism, Eugenics, Aryanisation), explain how the Nazi regime justified and implemented its persecution of *Jewish people* between 1933 and 1939.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal link between core Nazi ideological concepts (such as 'Social Darwinism' and the idea of 'Untermenschen') and the specific policies of persecution enacted against *both* disabled individuals and Roma/Sinti people between 1933 and 1939.

Complex Causal Reasoning

Q5. To what extent was the persecution of *all* minority groups (Jews, Roma/Sinti, disabled, homosexuals, and 'asocials') between 1933 and 1939 driven by a single, overarching Nazi goal, or were there distinct, separate motivations for persecuting each group? Justify your answer with specific evidence from the lesson.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Interpretation 1 (The Planned State Pogrom View):

The anti-Semitic violence of Kristallnacht was a highly coordinated, systematic operation planned and executed entirely from above by Joseph Goebbels and the paramilitary SA, aiming to force Jewish families into absolute economic and physical isolation.

Interpretation 2 (The Public Fear/Isolation View):

While the state-controlled press portrayed the violence of Kristallnacht as a spontaneous outburst of public anger, many ordinary Germans watched the destruction with deep alarm, concern, and disapproval. However, they remained completely silent and conformed to the regime's actions solely out of terror of the Gestapo and fear of immediate arrest.

Q6. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the events of Kristallnacht. What is the main difference between these views?

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q3B INTERPRETATION DIFFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q7. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the events of Kristallnacht. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

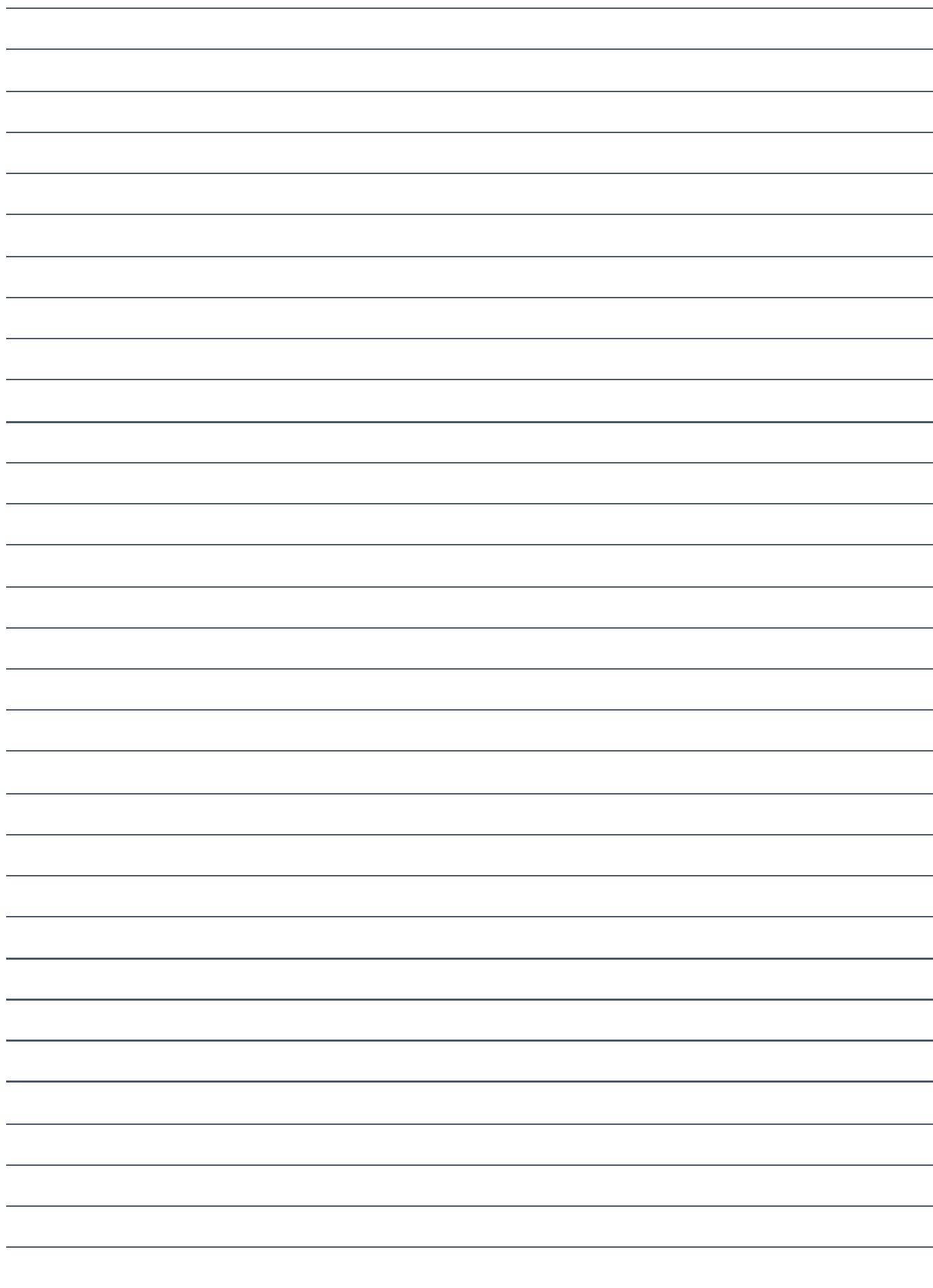
EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q3C INTERPRETATION WHY)

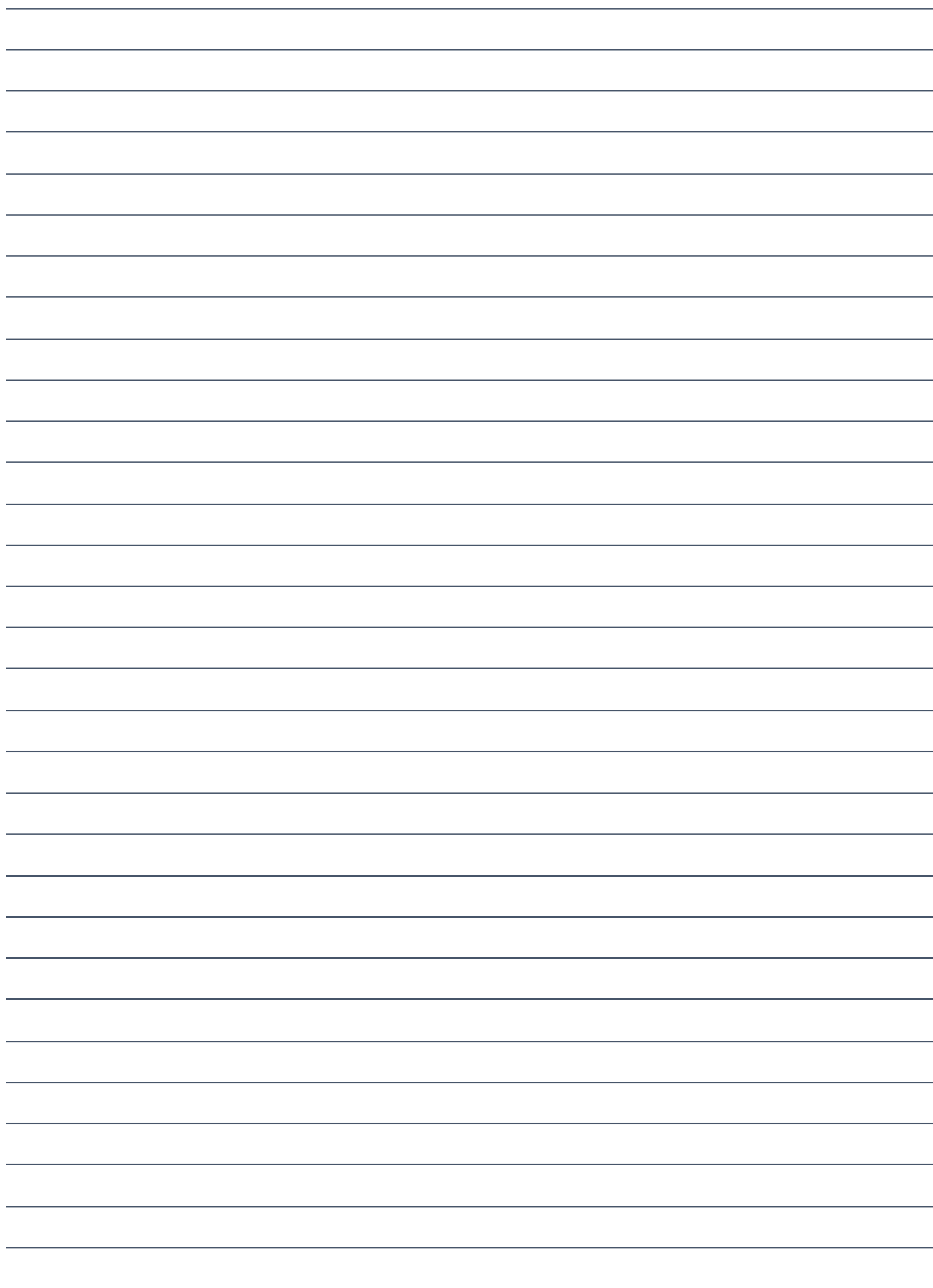
[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the events of Kristallnacht? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q3D INTERPRETATION EVALUATION)

[16 marks • 20 mins]







TEACHER FEEDBACK & D.I.R.T.

Mark: _____ / 16 (+4 SPaG) | Effort: 1 2 3 4 5

SPaG Self/Peer Checklist (4 Marks):

☐ Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. Reichstag, Ebert)

☐ Historical terminology spelled accurately

☐ Punctuation separates complex clauses

What Went Well (WWW):

Even Better If (EBI):

Student D.I.R.T. Response / Correction:

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** 2 3 4 **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)